Gateway Migration — Decision Record (draft 3)

Decision: We selected the Stripe-adapter microservice over direct vendor SDK integration for the transaction routing service.

Reasoning: Direct SDK integration tied our core payments flows to one vendor's client library lifetime and gave us no control over edge-case handling during gateway outages. The adapter service isolates vendor behaviour behind our own interface and keeps the legacy refund reconciliation path intact while the migration completes.

Architecture owner: Aarav Mehta (Payments Platform team).
Implementation owner: Sofia Lindqvist (Transaction Services).

Approval: signed off in architecture review, 14 March 2026.

Gateway Migration — Decision Record (draft 3), continued

Related decision: The legacy transaction-processing service (internal codename "TF-Bridge") is scheduled for decommission after two clean settlement cycles. TF-Bridge contains unreferenced reconciliation jobs that must be inventoried before removal.

NOTE: The decommission decision above was recorded without a named owner because the last maintainer left the team before this record was drafted. Whoever takes over payments work must confirm an owner for the TF-Bridge inventory in their first week.

Open follow-up: final vendor sandbox dataset location was never documented — the test-data scripts reference a bucket that is no longer mounted.